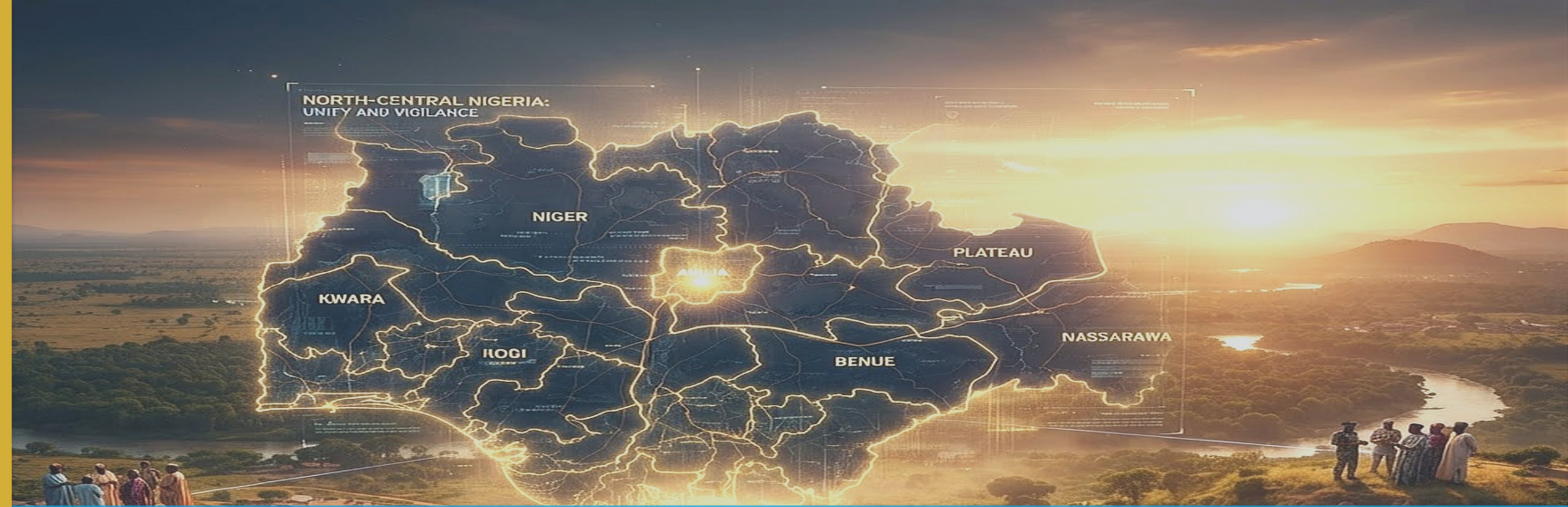




NORTH-CENTRAL NIGERIA SECURITY SUMMIT

COLLABORATIVE APPROACHES TO STRENGTHENING SECURITY IN NORTH-CENTRAL NIGERIA

Towards a People-Centred, Intelligence-Led and Sustainable Security Architecture

01

Air Vice Marshal Monday Riku Morgan (Rtd) | Former Chief of Defence Intelligence

30-Minute Keynote



SECTION 1

The North-Central Paradox

02

**Benue • Kogi • Kwara • Nasarawa •
Niger • Plateau • FCT**

- ▶ **Bridge between North and South — the heartland of Nigeria's territorial cohesion**
- ▶ **Home to vital agricultural lands, forests, water resources and mineral deposits**
- ▶ **Yet increasingly an arena of insecurity, displacement and communal tension**
- ▶ **Kidnapping, banditry, and violent competition over land and resources**

THE QUESTION

Not simply: who is responsible for the insecurity?

The deeper question: why, despite the Armed Forces, Police, intelligence agencies, civil defence, state institutions and traditional structures, does insecurity keep reproducing itself?

This paper submits: the challenge is not the absence of institutions.



OPENING — THE SCALE OF THE CRISIS

The Human Cost, In Numbers

03

SIX FIGURES THAT DEFINE THE PROBLEM

- ▶ **140+ killed — Plateau State, December 2023.**
- ▶ **1,043 killed in Benue State, May 2023 - 2025.**
- ▶ **160 killed in a single night — Yelwata.**

ACCOUNTABILITY

9 individuals have been charged with terrorism over the Yelwata killings. The numbers behind them are why this keynote exists.



A threat is seen — but seen by everyone, owned by no one.

THE PROBLEM:

“Information that does not reach a common system remains merely information.”

THE STAKES:

“Information that does not produce action cannot protect lives.”

Not occasional meetings between agencies — one common security framework, understood at every level of government.

INTEGRATED

Capabilities are integrated

COMPLEMENTARY

Responsibilities are complementary

ENGAGED

Communities are engaged

EXPLOITED

Technology is exploited



SECTION 4

Four Shifts the North-Central Must Make

06

Agency-Centric
→ System-Centric

Reaction
→ Prevention

Isolated Intel
→ Fusion
*“Nigeria already
embraces this at*

Govt-Only
→ Partnership

NDLEA /
Customs

*national level – the
NCTC’s Whole-of-
State Government,
Councils
Whole-of-Society
principle. The North-*

Local Govt
Structures

Traditional
Institutions

*Central must take it
Community,
further, & Civil Society*

1

Israel: intelligence, military, emergency structures and communities fused into one
~~Resident system~~
Britain: institutions retain distinct roles, coordinated within one national framework

2

Nigeria cannot simply copy either model

3

4

We must build a Nigerian model — our own hybrid

5

Combining intelligence fusion, inter-agency coordination, and community early warning

TOWARD A NIGERIAN MODEL

- ▶ Intelligence fusion (Israel)
- ▶ Institutional coordination (Britain)
- ▶ State & local government participation
- ▶ Traditional institutions & community early-warning
- ▶ Modern technology
- ▶ The reservoir of retired military, intelligence & police professionals

ISRAEL • BRITAIN • NIGERIA

- ▶ Not whether Nigeria has enough security agencies — we do.
- ▶ The real question: are agencies, governments, communities and citizens connected enough to act as one system?
- ▶ Two nations offer proven, opposite-but-complementary answers: Israel and Britain.

WHY THESE TWO

Israel: deep integration under sustained threat. Britain: coordination without destroying institutions. Together they map the Nigerian hybrid.

UNITED KINGDOM —

~~COORDINATION, NOT~~

► ~~CONTEST: Prevent, Pursue, Protect, Prepare~~ — four pillars, one strategy

- 43 police forces cooperate nationally — capability surges, local ties stay intact
- CTOC turns shared intelligence into action faster
- Principle: centralise intelligence & standards; decentralise implementation

ISRAEL — INTEGRATION AS DOCTRINE

- NSC fuses intel, political, military & government info into one national assessment
- Home Front Command links military capability directly to local authorities
- Chain: intelligence → decision → command → local authority → community → response
- The citizen is not a victim waiting for government — the citizen IS the architecture

HOME FRONT COMMAND

- ▶ The Home Front Command keeps a continuous relationship with local authorities.
- ▶ Exercises, emergency plans, and a direct link between military capability and civilian structures.
- ▶ The citizen is not a victim waiting for government — the citizen is part of the security architecture.
- ▶ Our communities already know who is entering the forest, who is moving cattle, who is unfamiliar — often

THE PRINCIPLE

Intelligence to decision to command to local authority to community to response — a continuous loop, not a one-way order.

WHAT WE BORROW — AND WHAT WE DON'T

- ▶ Permanent intelligence fusion.
- ▶ Strong regional operational coordination.
- ▶ Military-police-intelligence integration.
- ▶ Prepared local authorities.
- ▶ Community participation and resilience.

THE CAVEAT

We do not copy Israel's highly militarised environment wholesale — Nigeria is a larger, more diverse federation with different realities.

FOUR PILLARS, ONE STRATEGY

- ▶ **CONTEST: Prevent, Pursue, Protect, Prepare** — linking government, intelligence, police, military, emergency services, local authorities and communities.
- ▶ **Forty-three police forces across England and Wales, plus Scotland and Northern Ireland, cooperate through one national counter-terrorism structure.**
- ▶ **Capability surges to wherever the threat is greatest, without**

THE CTOC

The Counter Terrorism Operations Centre converts intelligence into action faster by putting agencies and policing in the same room.

ONSA / NCTC

- ▶ Nigeria's NCTC already runs an all-source intelligence function under ONSA.
- ▶ Whole-of-Government, Whole-of-Society is already our stated doctrine.
- ▶ The gap is not institutions. It is integration between them.

THE PRINCIPLE

**Centralise intelligence.
Decentralise delivery. Let every agency keep its identity while operating toward one national objective.**



Dimension	Israeli Model	UK Model
Intelligence	Highly integrated	Highly coordinated
Military role	Very prominent	More specialised
Local authorities	Strong emergency role	Strong prevention role
Community	Active security participant	Prevention & resilience partner
Command	Strong operational integration	Networked coordination
Technology	Very intensive	Very intensive
National strategy	Strong central direction	Strong central framework
Best lesson for Nigeria	Integration & rapid response	Coordination & institutional balance



SECTION THIRTEEN

The Hybrid Model — The NCISRM

15

THE NORTH-CENTRAL INTEGRATED SECURITY & RESILIENCE MODEL

- ▶ Israeli intelligence integration.
- ▶ Israeli local resilience.
- ▶ British institutional coordination.
- ▶ Nigerian community intelligence.

ONE SENTENCE

Neither model copied wholesale — a deliberate Nigerian hybrid, built for our federation, our geography and our communities.



The NCISRM — Five Levels, One System



**Level 1: Regional Fusion Centre • Level 2: State Coordination Centres •
Level 3: Local Security Network • Level 4: Forest & Rural Layer • Level 5:**

The Citizen
Five levels, one threat picture — from the regional fusion centre
down to the citizen, who must become a sensor in the network,
not simply a casualty statistic.

ONE STRUCTURE PER HIGH-RISK LGA

- ▶ Security agencies + traditional institutions + local government + community leaders.
- ▶ Farmers + pastoralists + credible civil society + trained community observers.
- ▶ One integrated structure per high-risk LGA — structured early warning, lawful information sharing.
- ▶ This is not vigilante justice.

THE GOAL

Turn scattered local knowledge into one lawful, structured channel that reaches the state coordination centre in minutes, not weeks.

NCISRM Level Four — The Forest and Rural Security Layer

DENY SANCTUARY, NOT THE FARMER

- ▶ **Forests and rural spaces cannot remain intelligence black holes.**
- ▶ **Rangers become the eyes and ears of the state — trained, equipped, connected.**
- ▶ **Specialised units retain the high-risk operations; rangers are not asked to fight wars.**

THE PRINCIPLE

Deny sanctuary, mobility, supplies, communications, financing and movement to armed groups — without criminalising the honest farmer or herder.



THE CYCLE THAT REPEATS

- ▶ An attack occurs. People are killed.
- ▶ Police are alerted. The military is mobilised.
- ▶ The attackers vanish. The community is searched.

THE ENORMITY OF THE PROBLEM
No amount of additional manpower fixes a cycle that is structurally reactive. This is the scale we must design our way out of — not police our way out of.



THE CITIZEN AS SENSOR

- ▶ Who do I call?
- ▶ What do I report?
- ▶ How do I report it?
- ▶ What happens after I report it?

THE STANDARD

The citizen must become a sensor in the security network — not simply a casualty statistic.

- ▶ A large pool of experienced retired military, intelligence & police professionals
- ▶ Contributes intelligence analysis and strategic planning
- ▶ Delivers training, mentoring and simulation exercises
- ▶ Strengthens early-warning systems and lessons-learned review
- ▶ Never replaces serving personnel — strengthens the system instead

REGIONAL SECURITY ADVISORY & TRAINING RESERVE

Veteran Reserve

Intel Analysis

Strategic Planning

Training & Mentoring

Early Warning

Lessons Learned

Attack, deploy, fight, withdraw, wait — that is reactive. Information, analysis, early warning, prevention, response, recovery — that is

PREVENT

PURSUE

PROTECT

PREPARE

PARTNER

COLLABORATIVE SECURITY

The Nigerian answer: Israeli integration + Israeli local resilience + British

coordination + Nigerian community intelligence — the NCISRM.

NO INTELLIGENCE ISOLATED. NO COMMUNITY DISCONNECTED.

- ▶ **Israel:** no intelligence should remain isolated, and no community should remain disconnected from the security system.
- ▶ **Britain:** different agencies can retain their identities while operating toward one national objective.
- ▶ **Nigeria:** our solution must be built around our geography, our communities, our constitutional structure and our own realities.

THE SYNTHESIS

Three lessons. One system. A model that is unmistakably Nigerian.

UNMISTAKABLY NIGERIAN

- ▶ **Centralised intelligence. Integrated command. Decentralised community engagement.**
- ▶ **Technology-enabled surveillance. Prepared local authorities. Veteran expertise.**
- ▶ **Early warning. Rapid response. Continuous learning.**

NINE COMMITMENTS

These nine commitments are the measurable core of the NCISRM — what North-Central Nigeria will actually build, together.



“He simply wants to arrive alive.”

Not a soldier in every village — a system where intelligence reaches the right commander, the commander reaches the right capability, and the capability reaches the threatened community before the attack occurs.

THANK YOU — Air Vice Marshal Monday Riku Morgan (Rtd)



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